



Grade 3 Language Arts

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 3 · FULL YEAR

~12½ hrs per week · 150 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Grade 3 Language Arts is a yearlong reading and writing course built around six core books. Scholars read whole novels at a steady pace of about one to two chapters a day, practice a weekly "What Good Readers Do" skill, and write every week, moving from personal narrative to opinion, expository, and research writing. Daily word work in morphology (meaningful word parts), spelling, and grammar builds the decoding and writing foundation that fourth grade will assume.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Launch + *Flat Stanley* (Weeks 1–5)

Reading routines and a first novel study; scholars plan, draft, and publish a personal narrative.

3 *The Whipping Boy* (Weeks 13–16)

Conflict and character perspective; scholars write an opinion piece with reasons and text evidence.

5 *Gulliver's Stories* (Weeks 22–25)

Adventure reading feeds expository writing: organized notes, drafts, and a published piece.

7 Year-End Synthesis (Weeks 31–32)

Scholars compare characters across the year's books and complete a final project or portfolio reflection.

2 *The Tale of Despereaux* (Weeks 6–12)

Character, motivation, and theme in a longer fantasy; scholars write and publish a fictional narrative.

4 *The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe* (Weeks 17–21)

Fantasy worlds, symbolism, and theme; literary responses and a whole-book assessment.

6 *Joan of Arc* (Weeks 26–30)

Biography and research: scholars choose a question, gather facts, and publish research writing with a short oral presentation.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Novel reading on a four-day cycle, about 1–2 chapters or sections a day, with a weekly "What Good Readers Do" reading skill.
- Word work every week: morphology (prefixes, suffixes, and roots), spelling patterns, and grammar taught in service of clearer writing.
- Writing connected to the reading, building through the year from narrative to opinion, expository, and research writing.
- Fluency practice, discussions, and assessments as each book closes.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

TIME COMMITMENT

750 minutes / week

≈ 2½ hours a day, Monday–Friday

- A typical day blends novel reading, word work, grammar, and writing.
- The scope and sequence plans four core ELA days each week; scheduled time also supports fluency practice, assessment, and review.
- Publishing weeks may run longer as drafts become final pieces.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A copy of each core book (home, library, or school-provided; approved texts can vary by section).
- A reading and writing notebook, pencil, and paper.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for typed and published writing.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily as a core course.